

Qroo Spanish Crew

Conjugating Verbs in the Present Subjunctive

Introduction

The present subjunctive in Spanish is formed by starting with the **yo** form of the present indicative, dropping the final **-o**, and then adding the subjunctive endings. These endings vary depending on whether the verb ends in **-AR**, **-ER**, or **-IR**. This guide focuses exclusively on the conjugation patterns for regular and irregular verbs.

Regular Verbs

Regular verbs in the present subjunctive follow a predictable pattern once the base is established. Below are the endings for **-AR**, **-ER**, and **-IR** verbs.

Conjugation Endings for Regular Verbs

Subject Pronoun	-AR Ending	-ER/-IR Ending
yo	-e	-a
tú	-es	-as
él/ella/usted	-e	-a
nosotros/nosotras	-emos	-amos
vosotros/vosotras (Spain only)	-éis	-áis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	-en	-an

Examples of Regular Verbs

-AR Verbs

- **Hablar (to speak):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	hable
tú	hables
él/ella/usted	hable
nosotros	hablemos
vosotros	habléis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	hablen

-ER Verbs

- **Comer (to eat):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	coma
tú	comas
él/ella/usted	coma
nosotros	comamos
vosotros	comáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	coman

-IR Verbs

- **Vivir (to live):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	viva
tú	vivas
él/ella/usted	viva
nosotros	vivamos
vosotros	viváis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	vivan

Irregular Verbs

Irregular verbs in the present subjunctive typically have irregular stems or forms that need to be memorized. These include verbs with stem changes, spelling changes, and completely irregular forms.

Verbs with Stem Changes

Stem-changing verbs follow the same pattern as in the present indicative, except **-IR** verbs also change in the **nosotros** and **vosotros** forms.

e > ie / o > ue

- **Pensar (to think):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	piense
tú	pienses
él/ella/usted	piense
nosotros	pensemos

vosotros	penséis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	piensen

- **Poder (to be able to):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	pueda
tú	puedas
él/ella/usted	pueda
nosotros	podamos
vosotros	podáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	puedan

e > i

- **Pedir (to ask for):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	pida
tú	pidas
él/ella/usted	pida
nosotros	pidamos
vosotros	pidáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	pidan

Spelling Changes in -car, -gar, -zar Verbs

Verbs ending in **-car**, **-gar**, and **-zar** undergo spelling changes to maintain pronunciation.

- **Buscar (to look for):** yo busque, tú busques, él/ella/usted busque, nosotros busquemos, vosotros busquéis, ellos/ellas/ustedes busquen
- **Pagar (to pay):** yo pague, tú pagues, él/ella/usted pague, nosotros paguemos, vosotros paguéis, ellos/ellas/ustedes paguen
- **Empezar (to start):** yo empiece, tú empieces, él/ella/usted empiece, nosotros empecemos, vosotros empecéis, ellos/ellas/ustedes empiecen

Completely Irregular Verbs

Some verbs have entirely irregular forms in the present subjunctive:

- **Hacer (to do/make):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	haga
tú	hagas
él/ella/usted	haga
nosotros	hagamos
vosotros	hagáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	hagan

- **Ser (to be):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	sea
tú	seas
él/ella/usted	sea
nosotros	seamos

vosotros	seáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	sean

- **Ir (to go):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	vaya
tú	vayas
él/ella/usted	vaya
nosotros	vayamos
vosotros	vayáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	vayan

- **Haber (to have):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	haya
tú	hayas
él/ella/usted	haya
nosotros	hayamos
vosotros	hayáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	hayan

- **Saber (to know):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	sepa
tú	sepas

él/ella/usted	sepa
nosotros	sepamos
vosotros	sepáis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	sepan

- **Estar (to be):**

Subject Pronoun	Conjugation
yo	esté
tú	estés
él/ella/usted	esté
nosotros	estemos
vosotros	estéis
ellos/ellas/ustedes	estén

Summary

The present subjunctive involves consistent endings for regular verbs and some predictable changes for irregular verbs. It is essential to start from the **yo** form of the present indicative and adjust the endings as needed. With practice, the patterns will become familiar and manageable.